Sahaj Bhadja

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OpenAI Hiring Team
Full Stack Software Engineer, Product Explorations
San Francisco, CA

Dear OpenAI Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Full Stack Software Engineer role on OpenAI's Product Explorations team. I am drawn to the opportunity to turn new model capabilities into experiences that people find useful, then use their feedback to decide what to build next. My work spans full stack development and applied AI, with hands-on experience building tools for real users and improving the systems behind them.

At USC Dornsife, I helped build a generative AI education pilot using Next.js, FastAPI, and Supabase. The platform supports roughly 350 daily users and more than 5,000 monthly jobs, with workflows for individual model responses, comparisons, orchestration, and evaluation across multiple model providers. This work connected user-facing product development with backend APIs and data modeling. I also optimized database queries and an internal dashboard, reducing response time from 1.2 seconds to 350 milliseconds. It taught me to consider the whole experience: a useful AI capability needs a clear workflow and a responsive, reliable system.

I enjoy building within tight constraints and making deliberate choices about scope. For a recent Local Events App case study, I built a FastAPI backend and simple UI around JamBase data, prioritizing location-based discovery and information that helps users choose an event. I used a provider interface, caching, and retry logic to keep the implementation focused while allowing it to evolve. Testing against live data exposed an edge case that I corrected. I used AI development tools to accelerate implementation while reviewing their output and documenting the tradeoffs.

My M.S. in Computer Science from USC and applied machine learning projects give me a foundation for collaborating across engineering and research. In a dental image classification project, I evaluated models on more than 11,000 images and used Grad-CAM to examine their predictions. I would bring this combination of product engineering and model evaluation to OpenAI: prototype quickly, test the assumptions behind an experience, and strengthen the ideas that show value for users.

OpenAI's emphasis on speed, ownership, and thoughtful experimentation aligns with how I like to work. I would welcome the opportunity to help the Product Explorations team discover and ship useful new AI experiences. Thank you for considering my application.

Best regards,
Sahaj Bhadja